RADIO FREQUENCY REGULATION 4

Background and legal basis of the regulation

The Regulation concerns the use of radio frequencies. Its objective is to guarantee a fair availability of radio frequencies and efficient, appropriate and sufficiently interference-free use of frequencies.

The Regulation is issued under section 96, sub-section 1 and section 97, sub-section 2 of the Act on Electronic Communications Services (917/2014).

The Radio Frequency Regulation concerns the radio frequency spectrum 100 Hz – 400 GHz. The Frequency Allocation Table annexed to the Regulation contains provisions on the allocation of different radio frequencies, frequency bands and sub-bands for different purposes of use. The Table also contains the requirements for transmitting and receiving frequencies and the used channel spacing. The Table also contains provisions on radio transmitters' bandwidth of transmission, duplex separation, transmitted powers and other corresponding radio characteristics. The Frequency Allocation Table annexed to the Regulation also applies to electrical equipment that are used for scientific, industrial, medical or other similar purposes and designated to generate radio frequency energy (ISM equipment).

The Frequency Allocation Table also takes into consideration the Radio Regulations of the International Telecommunication Union (ITU), which have been implemented in Finland by Decree 12/2000.

The Regulation requires regular updates, which are based on international frequency rules and recommendations as well as currently planned changes to the utilisation of frequency bands.

Other related regulations and statutes

The use of radio transmitter frequencies is also subject to the provisions of the Finnish Transport and Communications Agency’s Regulation 15 on collective frequencies for licence-exempt radio transmitters and their use. Regulations 4 and 15 are updated simultaneously.

Objectives of the Regulation

The objective of the Radio Frequency Regulation and the radio frequency utilisation plan is to safeguard the efficient use of the radio frequency spectrum. The radio frequency utilisation plan is published with the aim of supplying equipment manufacturers and users with information on the use of radio frequencies and on the protection against interference provided for radio networks by means of frequency planning. In addition to equipment design applications, manufacturers need this

information in order to fulfil their obligations under Article 10 of Directive 2014/53/EU regarding the information to be included in user instruction manuals.

Drafting process

Stakeholder consultations took place between 22 August and 22 September 2025 via Lausuntopalvelu.fi. Information on the request for comments was provided on the Agency's website and via email to stakeholders.

After the national consultation process, the Ministry of Economic Affairs and Employment notified the European Commission of the Regulation between 4 December 2025 and 5 March 2026 (3 months) in accordance with Directive (EU) 2015/1535.

Comments received through consultation

The comments received during stakeholder consultation are available (in Finnish) on the website Lausuntopalvelu.fi.

Changes and impact assessment

The amendments being now made to the Regulation update conditions for the use of frequencies and implement European frequency decisions.

The new Regulation, 4 AG/2026M, includes, for example, the following amendments:

Fixed service

More channels allocated to radio links in the 8 GHz frequency band: The channel plan for 56 MHz channels has been extended from three to five channels. The use of mobile programme transmission links in the frequency band has ended.

More channels allocated to radio links in the 23 GHz frequency band: The channel plan for 56 MHz channels has been extended from two to nine channels.

Land mobile service

The names of sub-bands allocated to PMR use have been changed, extending or specifying the current use of certain sub-bands and improving the readability of the Frequency Allocation Table.

Short Range Devices

The sub-band for wide-band data transmission equipment intended for data networks has been extended to include the sub-band 916.4–919.4 MHz and the sub-band for non-specific short-range devices to include the sub-band 916.1–919.4 MHz in accordance with Commission Implementing Decision (EU) 2025/650.

Military use

The allocation to "Mobile" corresponding to military use in the sub-band 230–240 MHz has been changed from secondary to primary use.

Government

The sub-band 738–753 MHz has been allocated to use by public authorities. The sub-band usage plan is still under review.

All amendments are listed in a separate annex to the Radio Frequency Regulation.

Entry into force

The amended Regulation enters into force on 31 March 2026.